

Topic: Life in Makkah

Boycott of Banu Hashim

Q (a) Give a detailed account of Quraysh's boycott of Banu Hashim. [10]

Structure of Answer		
Para 1	Para 2	Para 3
- Islam of Umar and Hamza (RA) gave new hope to Muslims. - Quraysh went for a final push when they could not stop Gradual Spread of Islam. - Gathering of Quraysh Notables and decision of Boycott.	- Except Abu Lahab Banu Hashim and Banu Abdul Muttalib were expelled from their houses. - Shaib-e-Abu Talib. - Most Horrible 3 years. - Intensity of Boycott and Height of Quraysh cruelty.	- Incident of Mansoor bin Ikrimah. - Uprising against Boycott. - Hasham bin Amr and others. - Termites ate the agreement. - End of Boycott (619 AD/ 10th YOP).

Answer

- ❑ Conversion of Hazrat Hamza and Umar (RA) gave new hope to Muslims and uplifted their morale because they were bravest and very influential people of Makkah.
- ❑ When Quraysh could not stop the gradual spread of Islam even after mental and physical torture, they went for a final push against Muslims.
- ❑ 616 AD (7th Year of Prophethood) notables of Quraish belonging to all major clans of Quraish gathered and decided to boycott Banu Hashim and their supporters socially and economically. The agreement was written by Mansoor bin Ikramah and later a copy of agreement was hung inside Holy Kaabah in order to legitimize this cruelty.
- ❑ All Muslims, whether they belonged to Banu Hashim or not and all members of Banu Hashim and Banu Abdul Muttalib, whether they were Muslims or not, were expelled from their houses. Abu Lahab was the only Hashemite who left Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) and chose oppressors' side.
- ❑ They all decided to stay at Shaib-e-Abi-Talib which was property of Abu Talib. It was located in a rocky region in outskirts of Makkah.
- ❑ The boycott was so intense. No one was allowed to keep any type of relationship with Banu Hashim. No one was allowed to do any type of Business with them.
- ❑ Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) and his companions faced toughest days of their lives. Kids would cry because of malnourishment and they had to eat grass and skins of animals. Saad bin Abi Waqas says:
 📖 "during a night my foot touched a wet thing, I picked it up and ate without investigating what it is"
- ❑ Abu Lahab would order all the traders to sell double price of everything if any member of Banu Hashim comes to buy. Life was ruthless for believers and their only crime was to believe in one God.
- ❑ Finger of Mansoor bin Ikramah (Who wrote the agreement) got paralyzed. That was the 1st sign that made Quraysh rethink about their cruelty.
- ❑ Hasham bin Amr was the first one who started agitation against this cruel agreement. At first, he along with Hakeem bin Hazaam started sending food to Banu Hashim secretly. Zuhair bin Umayyah (cousin of Holy Prophet) joined them in this cause. They convinced Mu'im bin Adi, Abul-Bukhtari and Zam'aa bin aswad to oppose this boycott. They raised their voice in next meeting of Quraysh notables, a lot of people were touched by their notion.
- ❑ Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) was informed that that hanged agreement inside Kaabah has been eaten by



terminals except Allah's name has been spared. Abu Talib informed this to Quraysh, they agreed to end this boycott if this was true and when they checked except word 'Allah' whole document was blank.

- ☐ Finally, in 619 AD (10th Year of Prophethood) this cruel boycott ended.
- ☐ Abu Talib along with his family members reached out Kaabah, held cover of Kaabah and prayed for wrath of Allah upon all those who made their lives miserable.

Q (b) What lessons do Present Muslim communities learn from this Boycott? [04]

Answer

- ☐ A very important lesson of Boycott of Banu Hashim is that loyalty is a matter of character not relationship. The way Prophet's (PBUH) Uncle Abu Lahab sided with Quraysh and betrayed family should be an eye opener for people.
- ☐ Muslims learn that difficulties come when your aim is high, but difficulties should not shake our will power. The way Muslims remained steadfast throughout 3 years of Boycott, was exceptional.
- ☐ Hasham bin Amr and other Makkans who played their role to end this horrible boycott, teach Muslims a lesson that people are basically good. One can find goodness as soon as He is honest and pure inside.

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